

compatibility. Consider that there are thousands of free software packages considered good enough to be in Debian, and many more that aren't on that project's radar.

You don't want to be compiling those yourself, particularly since dozens of releases happen every day. Also, you get to be part of the community that has formed around the base distro. Then again, free software means never having to ask permission before you create your fork.

The rise of Ubuntu has opened up one further possibility here, which is to fork from a fork. Previously, distros that forked from Debian had to cope with the outdated software problem themselves, but that was usually worth the bother because it meant you got to take advantage of Debian's huge software repository and unparalleled community testing. But Ubuntu does all that work already – it's based on Debian (even giving easy access to all of Debian's universe and multiverse repositories), then updates the software to newer versions and patches/fixes it all appropriately. The result is that you get all the size of Debian with all the latest features of Ubuntu. From your perspective, that means you can choose whether you want to base off Ubuntu or Debian, or indeed create a blend of both.

We're going to look at the methods, tips and essential knowledge required for constructing your own personalised distro, with a focus on modifying the hugely popular Ubuntu live CD. We'll also have plenty of other tips and guides for customising any Linux flavour.

How are we going to do this?

Using Reconstructor, an open source program written in Python that can create a customized Linux live CD distribution based on Ubuntu (Revisor for Fedora and SuseStudio are other alternatives). Reconstructor allows you to do extensive customisation by changing the splash screen, boot screen, sounds effect, wallpaper, programs and various other settings.

Installing Reconstructor

Reconstructor is very easy to install, with us not having to type even a few lines of code into a terminal window unless we desire to.

First of all, we have to make sure that our computer can